

Code of Conduct

Core standards for ethical behavior, professionalism, and compliance in a microfinance environment.

Module outcomes

- Practice ethical behavior in all transactions
- Protect client and employee information
- Understand non-negotiable conduct expectations

Professional Behavior

Every employee represents the company in front of clients, co-workers, regulators, and community partners. Professionalism must be visible in speech, appearance, punctuality, and work quality.

A respectful workplace strengthens trust and reduces risk.

- Treat clients and co-workers with dignity.
- Communicate clearly and avoid abusive, discriminatory, or threatening behavior.
- Raise conflicts through the proper reporting structure.

Integrity and Responsible Lending

Microfinance work requires honesty in documentation, collection handling, client interviews, and reporting. Employees must never alter records, hide discrepancies, or provide false assurances to clients.

Responsible lending means accurate verification, proper disclosure, and respect for client capacity to pay.

- Do not falsify client information, signatures, or financial records.
- Do not accept unauthorized gifts, commissions, or favors.
- Report suspicious activity, fraud indicators, or conflicts of interest immediately.

Confidentiality and Data Privacy

Client data, employee records, and internal documents must be protected. Access should be limited to business need and authorized roles.

Confidential information must not be discussed casually or shared outside approved systems and channels.

- Store forms and records securely.
- Avoid exposing personal data in public or unsecured spaces.
- Follow retention, access, and disposal rules for records.

Examples of Conduct Expectations

Area	Expected Standard	Red Flag
Client Interaction	Respectful, clear, and truthful communication	Pressure, misleading claims, or rude behavior
Documentation	Complete and accurate records	Altered, missing, or backdated entries
Cash / Collections	Official process, official receipt, timely turnover	Unrecorded handling or delayed remittance
Confidentiality	Need-to-know access only	Sharing files or credentials without authority

Note: This training file is a starter module for onboarding and can be uploaded into the LMS as learning content.